

Setting up a school tenant

A step-by-step operator tutorial, using the Cape Peninsula Schools Football 2027 season as the worked example · Internal · September 2026

This walks you through standing up a football schools tenant from nothing to released fixtures. Each step is small; the whole thing takes an operator about an hour, most of it in the calendar. For the concepts behind each step (what the sport profile is, why modules are off), read the companion guide

smart-school-vertical-guide.pdf first. Before you start you need: operator access, the league's districts and age groups, their term dates, and their affiliation deadline.

Step 1 · Create the client

- Operator console → **New client**. Pick a slug (it can never change).
- On the **Identity** step set **Sport = Football** and the **Season label** (Cape Peninsula uses “2027”). A panel appears listing what a football client starts without — read it once; the Deadline step repeats it before anything is created.
- Brand step: pick the base colour and Generate, or keep the default and refine later.
- Deadline step: the affiliation deadline (Cape Peninsula: 31 March 2027). Create the client.
- First admin: grant the league administrator's email — they sign in with an email one-time code. You are auto-admin on every tenant as an operator.

Check: open the new tenant's portal. The hero should read the league's name and season, and the admin console should show a 2-phase journey with no Compliance/CQI/Clearances/Veterans anywhere. If you see five phases, the sport didn't save — check the Vertical card in client settings.

Step 2 · Districts and age-group leagues

- Client settings → **Districts**: North, South, East, West, CBD & Atlantic Seaboard.
- Client settings → **Leagues**: one league per age group — Boys U15, Boys U17, Boys U19, Girls U14, Girls U16, Girls U19. Use “All districts” so every school sees them regardless of district.
- A/B/C squads are **not** separate leagues: a school entering U15A and U15B enters the Boys U15 league with a team count of 2. Team counts are set on the affiliation form.
- Add the **KO Cup** as one more league and tick “**Fixtures only (hidden from affiliation)**”. Schools will never see it as a choice; that's correct.

Step 3 · Calendars — the step people get wrong

A school season spans two terms with a holiday between. Build it as **one calendar block with a break**, never as two blocks: a round-robin cannot split across blocks, and a two-block setup refuses to generate (“does not fit”). You need two calendars, because the league and the cup exclude different dates:

Calendar	Block	Break	Cadence & exclusions
League calendar	13 Apr – 27 Aug 2027 (one block)	19 Jun – 19 Jul (school holidays)	Wednesdays. Exclude the Wednesdays of cup weeks (28 Apr, 5 May, 9 Jun, 11 Aug) so league rounds skip them
KO Cup calendar	26 Apr – 3 Sep 2027 (one block)	Same holiday break	Fridays. Exclude every Friday that is not a cup round; the final lands on Fri 3 Sep

Why Wednesdays and Fridays? The league's own week plan books league and cup rounds into the same school weeks twice. Different weekdays per competition keep any school off two fixtures on one day, and the clash checker will confirm it.

- Bind each age-group league's competition to the league calendar, and the KO Cup to its own calendar.

- Structures: a single round-robin for each age-group league; a knockout for the cup. The cup bracket size follows the entrant count (33–64 entrants gives 6 rounds; 12 schools would give only 4 — confirm the entry list with the league before promising round dates).

Step 4 · Copy, domain and comms

- Client settings → **Copy**: override the hero title, welcome and tagline so the login page speaks schools from the first visit.
- Domain: add the CNAME per the DNS sheet, as for any tenant.
- Check what schools will receive: the SES sender name and the Cognito invite wording are shared platform assets and may still read cricket — review before the first invites go out. WhatsApp stays off for school tenants; everything goes by email.

Step 5 · Onboard the schools

- Share the school signup link (client settings) or create schools yourself from the admin console; either way each school gets a Principal-level login.
- The school completes the 3-step affiliation: **School Details** (name, district, ground with map pin, number of fields), **School Leadership** (Principal, Director of Sport, Director of Football, Director of Academics, plus additional members), **Leagues & Coaches** (age groups + team counts, coaches with CAF/UEFA/SAFA bodies and levels A–D).
- Player registration: each school issues its own registration link from the portal. The public form asks for one football position and none of the cricket questions. A child already on another school's roster still registers fine — the row carries a “Previously registered at ...” note and the other roster is untouched; resolve duplicates from the admin Players view.

Step 6 · Cup entrants and fixtures

- Cup entrants: open each entrant school in the admin club editor and add the KO Cup under “Fixtures-only competitions”. Only admins can do this — school reps get an error by design.
- Generate each competition from the fixtures launcher, run the clash check, then release. Football fixtures show no overs; everything else (venues, releases, in-season edit guard) works exactly as for cricket.

Check: a school rep's Fixtures page shows their league rounds and, for cup entrants, the cup rounds too — even though the KO Cup never appears on their affiliation form.

Differences at a glance (school vs cricket tenant)

Where	Cricket tenant	School tenant
Admin nav	13 items incl. Compliance Docs, CQI, Clearances, Registration Reviews, Veterans	8 items; “All Schools” instead of “All Clubs”
Journey	5 phases, 20% each	2 phases (Affiliation, Fixtures), 50% each
Affiliation step 2	Executive Committee: Chairperson/Secretary/Treasurer/Vice-Chair	School Leadership: Principal + three Directors
Ground details	Venue + address + map pin	Same, plus “Number of fields”
Registration form	Batting/bowling profile, previous-club history, veterans question	One Position pick; nothing else
Player movement	Clearances with approvals and notifications	None — no-touch note, admin resolves duplicates
Coaches	CSA / Gary Kirsten, Levels 1–4	CAF / UEFA / SAFA, Levels A–D
Required documents	Seeded default catalogue	None seeded; add per league request

Where	Cricket tenant	School tenant
Comms	Email + WhatsApp templates	Email only
Tutorial videos	Built-in fallback library	Only what you upload for this tenant

Troubleshooting

- **Generate returns “does not fit”**: the season is split into two blocks. Rebuild as one block with a holiday break (Step 3).
- **“Where is the KO Cup on the affiliation form?”**: nowhere, by design — it's fixtures-only. Entrants are attached by admins (Step 6).
- **A school's save is rejected over a coach**: football tenants validate coaching body/level against CAF/UEFA/SAFA and A–D; fix the value rather than freeing the list.
- **Cricket wording on a school page**: hero/login text comes from the Copy slots (Step 4); anything else is a bug — report it.

Companion reading: [smart-school-vertical-guide.pdf](#) (concepts), [onboarding-a-tenant.md](#) (generic tenant onboarding), [league-structures-tutorial.pdf](#) (calendars and structures in depth).